

Topic 8: AI for Creative Writing

8.1 Fiction and Storytelling

- AI is useful for overcoming writer's block, generating ideas, and producing first drafts of scenes to react to
- World-building: 'Describe the political system, social structure, and geography of a society where [unique premise]'
- Character development: 'Create a detailed character profile for [description] including backstory, core motivation, fatal flaw, and distinctive speech pattern'
- Dialogue: 'Write a tense exchange between [character A] and [character B] about [conflict], revealing character through subtext'
- Plot paths: 'I have this premise [X] and want it to end with [Y]. Suggest 5 different plot paths between them'

8.2 Poetry and Experimental Writing

- Form-specific: 'Write a Petrarchan sonnet about [topic] following the ABBAABBA / CDECDE rhyme scheme'
- Style study: 'Write a short poem about [topic] using techniques characteristic of [poet] -- focus on their use of [specific technique]'
- Constraints generate creativity: 'Write a prose poem about memory using only monosyllabic words'
- Experimental forms: 'Tell this story entirely through a series of text messages between two characters'
- Use AI output as raw material and inspiration -- rarely use it as the final piece without significant personal revision

8.3 Screenwriting and Scripts

- Scene generation: 'Write a [genre] scene where [setup]. Character A wants [goal]. Character B wants [conflicting goal].'
- Dialogue polish: paste rough dialogue and ask AI to make it more natural, punchy, or specific to character voice
- Format: AI understands screenplay format (FADE IN, INT./EXT. LOCATION - TIME, character names in caps) -- specify the format
- Loglines: 'Write 5 loglines for a story about [premise] in the genre of [genre] -- each under 30 words'
- Pitch document: 'Summarise this screenplay concept as a 1-page pitch for a production company'

8.4 Maintaining Your Creative Voice

- AI output defaults to the statistically average style -- it needs your specific voice imposed on it
 - Use AI for quantity: generate 10 variations, apply your taste to select and refine the best
 - Avoid: accepting AI's first attempt, using AI for the emotional core or the ending, letting AI dictate the structure
 - Best creative workflow: outline yourself, write the opening paragraphs yourself, use AI to accelerate the middle sections
 - The more specific your prompt (specific character, specific moment, specific sensory detail), the less generic the output
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